



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE
April 2023

#4

COMING EVENTS

APRIL

1st Central Coast W'shop
6th Monthly Meeting
12th Committee Meeting
23rd Thirlmere Rail Museum

MAY

2-5th National Rally
10th Committee Meeting
13th Sydney Tech Day

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Fish & Chip Run – 18 March
By Denis Kasza

On Saturday Night, 18th March we had our Fish & Chip Run to Paradise Cafe, at Lower Portland on the Hawkesbury River.

Most of the 30 attendees met at McDonalds, McGraths Hill before setting off for a 45 minutes along a great road, in very pleasant late afternoon sunlight and shadows. The weather, having been very hot, by all accounts contributed to a great wind-in-the-hair ride.

Upon arriving at Paradise Cafe, the Austin-Healeys were lined up in front of the cafe facing the river, providing a very picturesque and romantic backdrop to dinner and drinks with singer/songwriter accompaniment.

Dianne Lawlor, Greg Strange with friend Ada Leung



Participants included:

George and Liz Goodare 100M, Ross and Jenny Penman BJ8, Alan Whitehouse and Jo Hutton BJ7, Daryll and Chery Dobe 100, Bob Ratcliffe BJ8, Ray and Muriel Roberts BJ8, (driven by grandson Josh House and mum Nicole House) as well as Jim and Felicity Barndon, Sprite.

Also present were Russell and Carol Kelly MG RV8 and the BJ9s of Patrick and Caroline Quinn, Christine Lyttle, Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith, Terry and Patricia Bancroft, Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor, with Ada Leung, Glenn House along with Susie Doctor and Denis Kasza.



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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Hybrid Meetings

Last month I was asking for an indication of who would attend an on-line meeting. Unfortunately, I only had three responses. A couple of weeks ago I gate crashed a hybrid meeting of the Z Car Club who also meet at Strathfield Golf Club to get the rundown on how this medium would operate.

As might be expected the average age of members of the Z Car Club is somewhat less than ours, and looking at their presentations which involved the use of drone photography, I think that we will need to start to include our grandkids more in our activities to keep up. However, I do not believe that the technology is beyond us to run a simple hybrid meeting and we will be discussing this at the next committee meeting.

One piece of equipment that would appear to be of importance for both the attendees in person and those online, is a central microphone/



speaker. I know that we used to utilise one while I was gainfully employed for our online meetings. That technology was later changed with speakers and microphones installed throughout the room so if any of you know where we can find a bit of this old technology then please let me know.

Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters

I was able to attend the inaugural meeting of these chapters. A great day organised by John Thornton, and it was good to see a few of our regular members, as well as some that I hadn't previously met from the Illawarra region who were enthusiastic about getting together

with Austin-Healey owners and looking forward to future events. I have no doubt that there will be stories and pictures of the day in this month's Flat Chat.

The day was not without some adventures for me. It absolutely bucketed down when descending Mt Ousley. I had taken along a mate, and I don't think he believed me when I told him that to stop and put the top up would get us a lot wetter, as would operating the windscreen wipers which would result in the water pooling around the back of the screen and onto his leg.

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COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

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Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
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It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
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Greetings and welcome to the April 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I trust that within its digital pages there is something you will find well worthwhile reading.

Sadly this issue carries the news of the passing of Philip Bloom, who I know will be greatly missed.

First it's a big thanks to the chapter people (is that their titles?) for writing out their exploits and sending them. I appreciate that to some, putting words together is about as interesting as pulling teeth, but I am pleased to say the words were received quickly. Thank you also to the committee members who have sent in their reports on what they have been up to. It's so important that all members have the opportunity of knowing what's been happening within the AHOC.

A big thanks has to go to Ian Richter who recently let himself be persuaded by Colin Rule that

he needed a 100 to restore. I am pleased to say that Ian has taken the trouble of putting some words and photos together telling the story for us all to enjoy, which I certainly did.

There are two really difficult jobs when it comes to the Quinn Austin-Healey and over the last month or so they have both been carried out. First is fitting a six-cylinder engine through a 100 bonnet opening. What a cow of a job, that has resulted in the car being booked in for quality time with Vince Cessario courtesy of Shannons. The second is fitting the radiator between two vertical uprights underneath the front shroud. Sounds easy, but it helps to have a rubber hammer and various pieces of timber to persuade it into place. You can tell for the below photo that it's now

in place. The radiator is actually the same as fitted to the Healey Duncan Saloon, except that it's pressurised.

Since then, the SUs are in place and the shafts, fulcrum and rods that form the throttle linkages are to follow. All so much fun, but somehow déjà vu isn't as good as it used to be.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Thanks again to Ian Richter who apart from setting off with the restoration of the 100, has also agreed to send in regular (perhaps monthly) updates of how he is going. It is very much appreciated. Please if you are doing some work to your car, let your fellow members know by sending in a few words and perhaps a photo or two.



Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**

Vale Philip Bloom

By Patrick Quinn



It is with sadness that we mark the passing of AHOC member Philip Bloom on Monday 27 March 2023.

I first crossed paths with Philip back in 2015 on advertising our first Healey Duncan Saloon. In what would be best described as an enthusiastic conversation, Philip responded saying that he was interested, but only wanted to buy the chassis and running gear, but not the body as he wanted to make a Silverstone replica. He exclaimed fairly strongly that I was asking too much for it.

Phillip called me a number of times over the next couple of months and while neither of us would change our position, it was clear that we were both enjoying the banter. I suggested to him that if he wanted a Silverstone, a batch of replicas was being built in the UK on original Healey chassis. Consequently, Philip bought one built on a 1952 Healey Abbott chassis.

It duly arrived and Philip found out that due to the total cost, it was subject to Luxury Car Tax. He was not impressed. Ensnared in his garage at his home at Belrose, Philip immediately joined the AHOC and became an active member. He was quite particular with his cars and our ongoing conversations focused on what he was doing with the car and how much he really did like it. We would joke that it would have been more economical if he had bought our first Duncan, than to have imported the car from the UK.

In 'A Word with Philip Bloom' published in Issue 23 of the *Australian Austin-Healey* we found out more

about him in that during 1960 he asked his girlfriend Fran to marry him, and not long after started a business in the veterinary supply industry. While Philip remained in the veterinary industry, the business changed to purely veterinary dentistry that is now managed by his son Lehman, who is also an AHOC member with a BJ8. Philip retired from what is now an industry leader in late 2022.

Philip's interest in cars was prevalent throughout his life. While attending Hawkesbury Agricultural College he bought an Austin A40 with his brother to get to and from their studies. That was followed by an Austin 7 Chummy that they rebodied into an open two-seater. Philip then became interested in Rileys and motorsport, running the Austin various Rileys in hillclimbs around Sydney. When the Dixon Riley came up for sale he bought that and raced it at Bathurst and Warwick Farm.

As an AHOC member Philip would strongly support gatherings such as the All British Day, Donald Healey Birthday Display Day and so on. The club had the pleasure of holding presentation lunches at his Belrose home and Philip was always a gracious host.

Philip was not hesitant at calling a spade a shovel and perhaps the best description I heard was from a friend who described him as "A tricky, brilliant force of nature, not a little intimidating at times, but a man who sailed under a different flag and a unique wind." Philip was 86 years of age and was a dear and valued friend. We will miss him.

Our condolences to Lehman and family.



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 2 March 2023

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

Meeting commenced at 7:45pm.

ATTENDEES

There were 26 members present (refer attendance list for details).

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

Visitors Paul & Mike Szewczyk were welcomed to the meeting.

APOLOGIES

Mark & Gabby Bancroft, Janice Burton, Bruce Ewan, Mal French, Garry & Julie Lee, Christine Lyttle, Doug & Pamela Ross

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 2 February 2023, as published in the March 2023 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim reported on activities both past and upcoming for the Central Coast, Mid-North Coast, Illawarra/Southern Highlands and Central West Club chapters. He advised that he'd finally been able to establish that Strathfield Golf Club could support hybrid meetings, so he planned to try this out to see if members were interested.

He'd been in contact with Bob Cutler about his honorary membership and Bob had passed on his regards. Bob said he'd also been trying to get in contact with Stephen Watson who'd purchased his 100 some 50 years ago. Stephen lived in the Jindabyne area, but Bob had lost contact with him.

Lastly, Jim was pleased to advise that following receipt of three nominations, the Committee had voted Bruce Ewan, Social Secretary Extraordinaire, as the very worthy winner of the Alan Jones Memorial Trophy.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

The only emails of interest were the various magazines received from other car clubs, plus some offers from Motorsport Australia.



TREASURER'S REPORT

Cash		
Account	Available	Concurrence
Cash Reserve Account 6/1/2023	\$21,912.79	\$21,912.79
Charles Run Account 6/1/2023	\$1,844.08	\$1,844.08
Debit Card 6/1/2023	\$88.62	\$88.62
Main Account 6/1/2023	\$36,155.60	\$36,155.60
	Cash accounts total	\$58,155.60
Investments		
Account	Available	Concurrence
Term Deposit 6/1/2023		\$10,000.00
	Investment accounts total	\$10,000.00

Income received was for memberships (\$410) plus social activities (\$570), with \$600 spent on trophies. Jenny also reported on the National Rally finance activity

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

In Bruce's absence, Denis provided a quick overview of the calendar for the next six months.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Pamela had sent cards to Garry & Julie Lee ("thank

you” for the Presentation Lunch), Ken & Jenny Krause (“glad you joined us at the Presentation Lunch”), and Patrick Quinn (get well). Pamela also thanked the Club for the get well card she’d received (via Alan Mitchell).

WEBMASTER’S REPORT

Jim reported that the admin features on the website were being updated and he would be creating new pages for each of the Club chapters

MEMBERSHIP

No Report

RALLY REPORT

Gordon provided an update on the upcoming National Rally and provided a taste of the many events that participants could expect to enjoy.



EDITOR’S REPORT

Patrick provided a status on the delivery of Flat Chat the previous evening.

REGISTRAR

Patrick advised that he was still being constantly asked about the process for historic vehicle registration.



HISTORIAN

Joe was pleased to report that Graham Healey had purchased an Austin-Healey and was living on the South Coast. From his vast store of information, Joe also talked about people involved in the design of the early Healey chassis.

LIBRARIAN

Ron advised that Gordon had donated a couple of books to the library.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/SPARE PARTS

Nothing to report

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Nothing to report.

CMC REPORT

Ray advised there’d been no meeting to report on.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

There was a possibility that the All British Day wouldn’t be held at The Kings School due to past impact on the grounds, but would move to another location and be held later in the year. More would be advised when known.

CSCA REPORT

Details for Round 1 of the Supersprint series was available on the Club’s website.

REGALIA

Colin was back to his best with trying to part members from their money with some great deals!

GENERAL BUSINESS

- Colin & Kerrie Rule had attended the inaugural North Coast chapter meeting and advised there’d been a good turnout, with Phil Lorking and Tony Ash officiating over proceedings.
- There was general discussion about camshafts and cam followers with the advice that members were better off getting second hand units reconditioned rather than buying new ones.
- Alan Mitchell provided an update on Don Read.

Meeting concluded at 8:25pm.



MEMBERSHIP REPORT

Christine Lyttle

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membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

New members this month are:

- Neil Mason as a full member from Kings Langley with a 1965 3000 MKIII Phase 2
- John Carrall as an associate member from Buhlahdelah with a 1972 Toyota Land Cruiser.

Welcome to the club and hope to see you at a General Meeting or an event soon.

Lincoln and Karina Sell have rejoined the Club, welcome back to you both and Mark Wilkinson has paid his membership.

Name badges for the above members will be ready to be distributed shortly.

Don't forget the Club has recently acquired credit card facilities which incurs a small surcharge of up to 2.2% of the cost of your membership, regalia item or rally ticket. Should you wish to use this service either at a club meeting, event, over the phone or entered on your membership form in the future we can certainly assist. Membership (me) and Regalia (Colin Rule) officehold-

Pres Message cont'

Last time I was at the HARS Aviation Museum I ran out of fuel about eight miles from the closest servo. To ensure that history didn't repeat itself I not only had five litres in the boot, but took the extra precaution of filling up before we left the 'Gong. I don't normally visit a BP servo, but did know that I needed to fill with 'Ultimate' fuel. After shoving the nozzle into the tank and watching the progress of the fuel going in, I noticed a "boost" button and thought that's unusual they usually have that on diesel. Yes I'd grabbed the 'Ultimate' diesel bowser and not the petrol one. I was then in a bit of a panic, as I'd thought that I'd poured six litres of diesel into the tank only for it to be pointed out to me by my travelling mate that it was \$6 and less than 3 litres. Well! We got home sort of okay periodically laying down a smoke screen, but have now learned my BP lesson.

May Meeting (May the 4th be with you)

Due to the National Rally coinciding with the next general meeting, we will not be having a meeting at Strathfield but will be getting together with the mem-

bers currently hold these devices so make contact with them to make the payment.

A further reminder, don't forget to advise me if you change your address, email or any other details online to ensure that we can keep your details as correct as possible, send any changes to membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au. Why not log in and check the website changes and you can update your details though I would like to be advised to ensure that I also have the correct information for you.

The National Rally at the Hunter Valley from 2 to 5 May is less than a month away and our committee is busy ensuring those attending will have a great time. If you wish to attend we need to know this week as numbers need to be finalised with Chateau Elan. Check the website for forms and details www.austinhealeynsw.com.au/2023-national-rally/ or contact me by email rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com. We will also need to confirm if there are any rooms available at the Chateau Elan as they have been open to the public since 1 February 2023.

Keep safe and well

Happy Healeying!
Christine Lyttle

bers of the other Austin-Healey clubs for a gala dinner to formally conclude the 2023 National Rally. However, this doesn't prevent any of you who are unable to attend the National Rally from getting together for a meal and a social get together. If anyone would like to be part of/organise such an event let me know and I'll issue invites through the website so that members can RSVP.

Easter

Easter is right upon us (how did it get here so quickly) so I take this opportunity to wish you all a happy Easter. For those of us who are retired, my observation is that public holidays have lost a lot of significance from when we were actively employed, but my hope is that this weekend will be an opportunity to rest, relax, spend time with friends and family, a time to hunt for Easter eggs, consuming hot cross buns etc. and even consider the reason for the season.

Happy Easter.
Jim Phillips

Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493

Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008

deniskasza@gmail.com

“Australia is a huge country!”. It will be of no surprise to anyone. NSW being the state with the largest population, also has one of the most active and energised Austin-Healey memberships in Australia. Given the size and breadth of the state, multiple chapters have evolved. It is really great to see this, which not only provide a way for Austin-Healey owners to meet and converse without travelling too far, but also provide the perfect opportunity for others to travel, meet members and form friendships in new areas.

As member participation increases, so does the diversity and extent of offering. March has delivered events on the Central Coast, in Sydney, Wollongong and the Illawarra, Bathurst and the Mid-North Coast.

Of course attending the workshops and social events also expands the horizons of all involved.

Many thanks to Richard Horwood for hosting the March Technical Workshop. Promoted as being held at the Mortlake SLSC, a tongue in cheek reference to the Sydney Harbour waterside offering that hosts Richard’s car collection.

Richard is an avid car enthusiast, with a wide and diverse collection of vehicles. This is also one of the best and most diverse Austin-Healey collections of NSW AHOC members. From highly original unrestored to newly restored earliest models, to the very

last offerings, Richard’s collection is impressive. Yet it also includes other marques.

The key factor that holds the collection together is Richards impressive knowledge and research that builds the story for each car.

Really great to see were a number of people that have been considering joining the club plus some incredibly rare cars, that even the most avid aficionado may never have seen.

Chris Shead attended in his Nash Metropolitan imported from the US and lovingly returned to factory over the past two years. Chris also convinced Laura Rafferty to attend in her matching UK simile Austin Metropolitan. With only a handful of known examples in Australia, it is rare to see the two cousins offering side by side. Laura is that rare breed of young female car enthusiast that has chased her dream after



Social Report Cont'

seeing a car, researched it thoroughly and then imported it from Belgium. It is really heartening to see someone who has rejected the hatchback offered in the millions for a unique and much more interesting transport.

All up there were 21 participants, in various Austin-Healeys from 100, 100/6, 3000 and Sprite. Attending were Greg Strange (Sprite), Greg Alexander (non-member with Greg Strange), Rod Richards, Neville Stirton (3000), Roger Ramsay, Ray Roberts, Allan Whitehouse (3000), Denis Kasza (Westminster), Ron Strange (3000), Ross Penman (3000), Damien Carrick (3000), Mark Sullivan, Doug Alexander, Richard Horwood (3000), Amer Khoury, Bob Ratcliffe, David Williamson, Laura Rafferty (Austin Metropolitan), (We are trying to get Laura to join) and Chris Shead (Nash Metropolitan)

This was a really fascinating morning, and there are many stories and a lot more to be told, yet rather than spill the secrets attend the next event.

Content from other events and chapters following.

Event: Thirlmere Rail Museum

Date: Sunday 23 April, 2023

Time: 11am to 2.30pm

Address: 11 Barbour Rd., Thirlmere

Depart: Frank Partridge VC rest stop at 10am for a 10.30 departure.

Note: Cafe and parking available at Thirlmere.

Below is cancelled due to the National Rally

Event: Central Coast Chapter Technical Day

Date: Saturday May 6, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber NSW 2251

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Event: Sydney Technical Day

Date: Saturday May 13, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: North Shore Location (TBC)

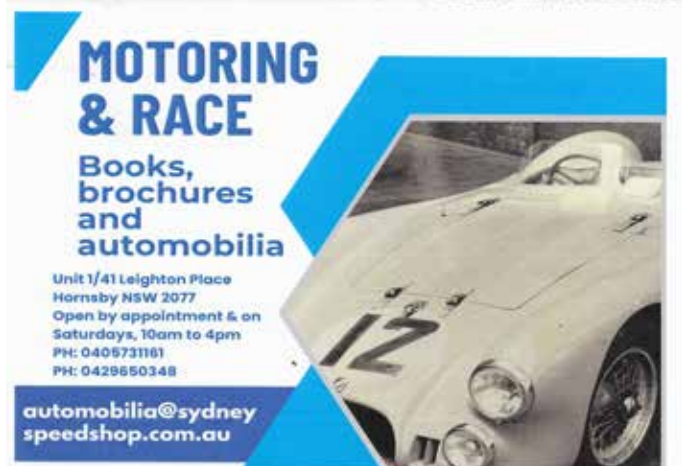
Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above.

Following on from this workshop there is the option to visit the Motoring & Race Book & Automobilia Shop

Unit 1/ 41 Leighton Place, Hornsby NSW 2077

**Event: Central Coast Chapter Technical Day**

Date: Saturday June 3, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber NSW 2251

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Event: Sydney Technical Day – Greg Strange Motor Mechanic

Date: Saturday June 10, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 117 Cleveland, Darlington

Topic: Working on the BMC Production Line in Sydney.

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above.

The April meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 6th at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the bistro with your fellow club members.

Chapter News

Central Coast Chapter – March Workshop

Another gorgeous Saturday morning for our Central Coast workshop get together on 4 March. This was held at Jenni and Ian Richter's beautiful property nestled in the foothills of Ourimbah.

A very big thank you to Jenni and Ian for hosting the workshop. The main emphasis of the morning was checking out Ian's new project, a 1954 Australian delivered BN1 100. Last registered, 12th month 1974.

The restoration is moving along very nicely with Ian devoting most of his spare time repairing or replacing bits and pieces to the chassis. Next comes the panels. Keep going Ian, you will get there in the end. Well done!!!

We had 20 devoted enthusiasts turn up on the morning and seven Austin-Healeys. A very warm welcome to Bob Crawford driving a very nice red 100 who incidentally is a long-time member of our club. Lives just down the road from Ian and Jenni.

Attendees were, Doug Ross BJ7, Garry and Julie Lee BJ8, Larry and Helen Johns 3000 Mk1, Jenni and Ian Richter BN1, Jim Phillips BN4, Anne and Lew McAllan Sprite MK1V, Bob Crawford BN1, Kerrie and yours truly BN2, Roger Ramsay, Annie and Mark McAllan, Louse Gabriel, Jacob, Tomas and Tiane Richter.

The morning finished up with the traditional coffee,



cookies and cake and what a gorgeous spread it was. The diet definitely flew out the window.

The next Central Coast workshop will be held on Saturday the 1st of April at 109 Humphreys Road Kincumber South with a 9.00am start. We will be looking at fixing a pesky "Rattly" turn indicator on a BN4.

Happy Healeying and all the very best for now. Kerrie and Col Rule.



Central Coast Chapter - 1 April Workshop

I've just realised you are receiving two Central Coast workshop reports for March and April in this issue of our Flat Chat Newsletter. Now that's a bonus!!!

A fantastic morning weatherwise with not a cloud in the sky, saw 18 enthusiasts turning up and ten Austin-Healeys, a 240 Z rally car, a competition Sunbeam Alpine a Bowell Nagari and a Club Sport Commodore.

The main focus for the day was to eradicate a pesky indicator/horn mechanism from rattling. This was achieved by removing the nut and olive from the steering box and sliding the stater tube back up through the steering wheel boss.

By cutting a small 3" x 1/2" upholstery leather strip and gluing in a conical shape around the top of the stater tube, we then used oil on the leather and replaced the stater tube and horn mechanism into its rightful place and tighten everything. Rattle eliminated; job done.

A big welcome to first time Workshopper Luke Scott. I invited Luke along while I was in his dentist chair giving my teeth the once over. I guess this is one way you can introduce newcomers to the Austin-Healey marque. This works!!!!

Attendees for the day were Suzanne Ellicott, Larry Johns 3000 (Mk1), Doug Ross BJ7, (oh yes, the other Doug Ross a very early club member), Richard Horwood Club Sport Commodore, Geoff Smith Bolwell, Louise Gabriel 100, Ian Richter, Mark McAl-lan BJ8 3000, Scott Parry-Jones BN4, John Wakeling Rally 240Z, Richard Cardew Sunbeam Alpine, Luke Scott, Julie and Garry Lee BJ8, Jim Phillips BN4, Kerrie and yours truly Bond 3000.

For your calendar, the May workshop will not happen due to the National Rally, so the next workshop will be held on June 3 with a 9am start and don't forget the cookies and cake. We may even go for a coffee run instead of our workshop. (Watch this space).

There is still an opportunity for those folk who would like to come to the National Rally who haven't yet booked. This rally is a great opportunity for like-minded Austin-Healey enthusiasts all over Australia and beyond to get together and share our experiences. See page 7

All the very best for now and happy Healeying. Kerrie and Col Rule.





Southern Highlands & Illawarra Chapters

The first meeting of the AHOC Southern Highlands and Illawarra Chapters was held 20th March 2023 at the Historical Aircraft Restoration Society (HARS) at Shellharbour Airport.

The intention was to have a meeting and a photo opportunity for Austin-Healeys under the wings of the Qantas VH-OJA Boeing 747-438.

It was great to see the support of AHOC members with Tony Ash driving down from the far north coast in his "Healey Hilton", Dennis Kazsa from Maroubra in his Austin Westminster. In Austin-Healeys were Colin Rule, Jim Phillips, Neville Stirton and Richard Horwood from Sydney and northern regions. And our editor from the northwest, Patrick Quinn attended.

It was wonderful to meet with Gerry South from St Georges Basin and David McIntyre from the Southern Highlands. Gerry was brave enough to take on the unkind elements (rain) all the way up from St Georges Basin to Kiama, to be greeted with a dry day at Albion Park. A great effort for David having driven his car up from Melbourne on the Sunday, after having a new hood fitted, getting up early to come down Macquarie Pass on the Monday morning and arrive well before the start of the event.

From the local Wollongong area were Robert and Anne Sassall, who live no more than a kilometre from Fran and I and whom we had not met before and Glenn Hogan whom I have seen a few times in his BJ7 heading up Corrimall Street, but never quick enough to catch him. Ah! you can see the benefits of having regular regional meetings.



Smoko in the Connie Cafe

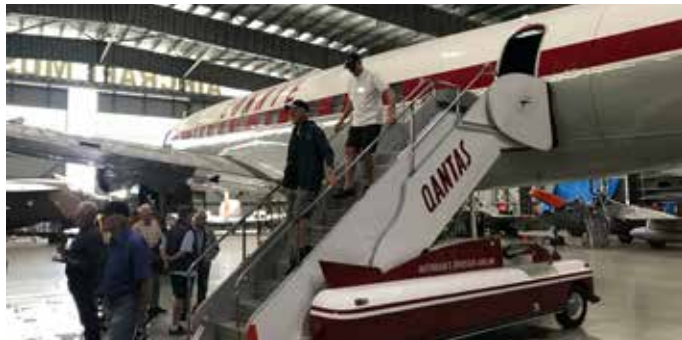


Guide taking AHOC members through what's on show.

HARS cont'

The local members supporting the day were Chris and Lyn Fitzpatrick, Graham and Leigh Healey, Joe Armour and his brother Peter, a number of friends of members, Fran and myself.

The Historical Aircraft Restoration Society (HARS) at Shellharbour Airport is an amazing collection of aircraft from all over the world. The knowledgeable guides pass on some much information and history of the aircraft.



Thank you to all who made this first meeting of the Southern Highlands and Illawarra Chapters a wonderful success.

All the best

John Thornton:

Email: John.thornton2011@outlook.com

Mobile: 0419 266 284



Tony Ash in deep technical discussion with a Qantas colleague on the restoration of the replica Southern Cross. The Southern Cross is due to fly in the 95th anniversary arrival of Charles Kingsford Smith and Charles Ulm at Sydney Kingsford Smith Airport celebrations on the 10th June 2023.



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Mid-North Coast Chapter – March Gathering

Saturday March 25 saw the meeting of the Mid North Coast Chapter of the AHOC. Being wet, plus voting day for the NSW state election meant that numbers were down compared with the previous month.

We had the pleasure of Richard Horwood and or son Simon Lorking who both made the effort to travel north for the day. Unfortunately, the Port Macquarie owners were unable to attend, but hopefully we will see them next month.

The morning tea discussions revolved around Simon's 100 project and Richard's many projects.

The next gathering of the chapter is scheduled for Saturday 22nd April here at Croki.

Phil Lorking

Unfortunately, due to a recalcitrant mobile phone camera there are no photos for us to enjoy. PQ.

Austin-Healeys at Phillip Island - Mar 10-12

Our club had three members running at the Phillip Island Classic over 10-12 March – Patrick Townshend-3000 Mk1, Becher Townshend-100/6 BN4

and Chris Komor – 100. Apologies to Chris that I do not have any photos of him competing so have included one of past member Peter Jackson.



Patrick Townshend



Becher Townshend



Peter Jackson



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Can someone out there help please?

The message is just not getting across to many of our members with vehicles on Conditional Registration. For three to four years the details of what's involved in renewing Conditional Registration has been included in each issue of Flat Chat.

I believe that it's written in simple language that cannot be misinterpreted, but perhaps I am mistaken. Just last week I had to visit the post office because one member thought the registration of his vehicle was so important, that the documents had to be sent by reg-

istered post, and even included a reply registered post envelope. All that managed to do was to slow down the process and piss me off by having to get in the car and drive to the post office.

Clearly the situation means one of two things. Either they don't read this page of *Flat Chat* or they don't read *Flat Chat* at all. Sadly, I suspect it's the latter, which frankly I can't understand as it contains information that concerns them as AHOC members.

Remember if you attend an AHOC event you do not need to fill in the logbook, but if you deviate from the event to go visiting, exploring or the like, that is not part of the event, you need to make an entry in your logbook.

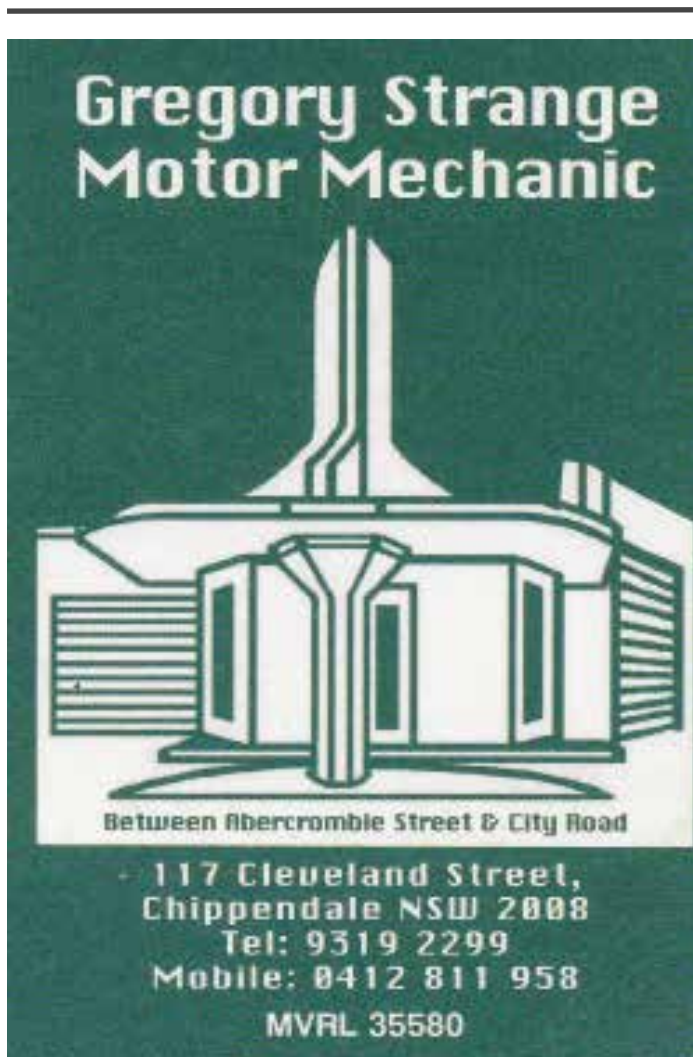
Again, the necessary renewal steps are indicated below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.

- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.

- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

DON'T FORGET THE STAMPED SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580



Gathering at McGraths Hill



Colin Goldsmith, Terry & Patricia Bancroft



Susie Doctor, Christine Lyttle and Liz Goodare.



Allan Whitehouse, Jo Hutton and Delwyn Goldsmith



Ray Roberts, Glenn House, Muriel Roberts, Josh House and Nichol House



APR
23



THIRLMERE RAIL MUSEUM

**10 Barbour Rd Thirlmere
11am - 2.30pm**

MEET AT PARTRIDGE VC REST STOP, HUME
MOTORWAY 10AM FOR 10.30 DEPARTURE
CAFÉS AND PARKING AVAILABLE AT THIRLMERE

PAINTED SILOS TOUR - 4th to 8th September 2023 - Itinerary

Monday - SEPTEMBER 4th

Depart Sydney
Travel to HARDEN MURRUMBURRAH
Silo location – Neill Street, Harden

Continue to GRENFELL

Silo location – 30 West Street, Grenfell

Continue to WEST WYALONG for overnight stay at either:-

CAMEO MOTEL, 263 Neeld Street, \$120/night, 6 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2255

Or

COLONIAL MOTOR INN, 4 Ungarie Road, \$ 130/night, 10 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2611

TOTAL 530 KMS FOR DAY



Grenfell



Harden



Weethallie

Tuesday - SEPTEMBER 5th

Depart West Wyalong to WEETHALLIE

Silo location – Railway Street, Weethallie

Continue travel on to DUBBO for overnight stay at

BLUE DIAMOND MOTOR INN, 113/115 Wingewarra Street, \$150/night, 10 Queen, 5 Twin rooms

Phone (02) 6882 0666

TOTAL 380 KMS FOR DAY



Dunedoo



Quirindi



Merriwa

Wednesday - SEPTEMBER 6th

Depart Dubbo to DUNEDOO

Silo location – Castlereagh Highway, Dunedoo

Continue to MERRIWA

Silo location – Hackets Road, Merriwa

Continue to QUIRINDI via SCONE

Silo location – Quirindi

Overnight stay at BEST WESTERN MOTEL/RSL, \$148/night, two people

Phone (02) 6746 1995

TOTAL 340 KMS FOR DAY



Barraba



Gunnedah

Thursday - SEPTEMBER 7th

Depart Quirindi to BARRABA,

Silo location – Manilla Road, Barraba

Continue travel to GUNNEDAH

Silo location – 2 Barber Street, Gunnedah

Overnight stay at the HARVEST LODGE MOTEL, 404 Conadilly Street, \$160 for night, 2 people

Phone: (02) 6742 3400

TOTAL 260 KM FOR DAY

Friday - SEPTEMBER 8th

Depart Gunnedah to PORTLAND

Silo location – William Street, Portland

NO MOTEL ORGANISED, SOME MAY WISH TO TRAVEL HOME.

IF NOT, BOOK A MOTEL

TOTAL 350 KMS FOR DAY TO PORTLAND



Portland

If interested call either Denis Kasza on 0407 492 008, Terry Bancroft 0409 323 133 or email bangers@bancroft.id.au



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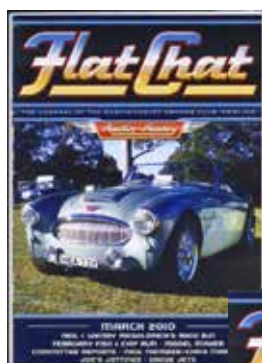
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through to April 2023.

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a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



The Project

By Ian Richter

It was unexpected, a small presentation of sorts. I had arrived just to gather up 'The Project' and Colin handed me an Austin-Healey sales brochure for a BN1 and an old grey dust coat. It was a gift that has great personal significance to me. These two items have survived many years and have come full circle. The gesture was deeply appreciated and touched me greatly, but more on that shortly.



Those of us who know Colin Rule would be well aware of his lifelong pursuit of the Austin-Healey marque. We often visit his workshop, not just as part of a AHOC gathering, but any time one needs car advice or just a chat. Colin is always generous with his knowledge and his time. His experience and capabilities in the restoration of Austin-Healeys are beyond reproach. I would say near perfect. So when I received a call from Colin about a project, it piqued my interest.

My mobile rang at work and I glanced across to see if it was a call I wanted to take. The name was familiar, and the call got preference over my current task. After a small exchange of words, Colin is straight to business. His voice is always enthusiastic, and he announces to me, "I have your next project, and do I have a deal for you."

Firstly, I didn't know I was looking for a project, and secondly, one should always be wary of a good deal, but the hook was in.

I invited myself over to Colin's workshop to take a look, not sure what to expect. The project appeared to be in two locations plus a couple of plastic boxes, all

covered with blankets of dust of varying thicknesses. That dust had cloaked these parts for many years. Had I misread Colin's exuberant description? "It's complete, it's all there, it's been there for 50 years." I clearly remember his remarks, "It is a project and will need some work." but I don't recall any mention of it being spread across two workshop bays.

There is always a story on how projects find their way to Colin. He is a magnet for Austin-Healeys. If you have been fortunate enough to venture into his workshop, you would know what I'm saying. Colin again regales the information I had received on the phone a few days back. "It's a BN1, 1954, it's been in Bob's shed for fifty years, Australian delivered, it's got all its numbered parts." I have to say his enthusiasm is infectious.

Part A of the project was sitting on the car trailer, covered. I could see how Colin's mind was working. Begin with the big impact first - the big reveal. He knew what was in front of him and the potential of this car. It was an opportunity to pull another Austin-Healey out of a woebegone state, but would I see it the same way? We pulled back the cover... Oh boy, Where do I begin?

I don't remember exactly when I first met Colin, but my memories start around the late '70s. The fact is that in 1970 Colin joined the bus company in Umina that my grandfather and his two brothers had just sold. The new owners employed Colin to do the panel and paintwork in the company's panel shop. My father Gordon was working in the bus company at the time, and he and Colin became work colleagues, no... good workmates.

We lived a few doors down, so I spent a bit of time at that bus depot in my early years, nosing around. I clearly remember the day when Colin's Ross Bond race 3000 appeared in the panel shop around 1980. My father gave me a sneaky look under the cover late one afternoon after work. This race Austin-Healey was next level for a young schoolboy. The only other Austin-Healey I had known was the red (BN1) car that Colin was restoring in the late '70s, which I often saw at the depot. One afternoon with a bit of encouragement from my father (although Colin didn't need much encouragement) he started the engine. It's been many, many years, but there are just some things you never forget. Colin gave that throttle some exercise. The

Project cont'

raucous chaos that erupted from the side pipe on engine start was glorious, but only lasted for five or maybe ten seconds, but the expletives from the mechanics on the other side of the panel shop wall lasted an easy minute. I clearly remember Colin's smirk, and his words were similar to "they get a bit upset when I do that." My grin lasted for hours.

What was sitting on the trailer after the big reveal was a BN1 chassis, inner body panels, engine, gearbox and four wheels. It's a car without its skin, and we have all seen these. The inner and outer sills on this BN1 needed some imagination on where they may once have been. Rust and any early British car fit neatly together. Colin stepped in, "This is good, keep this, replace that, I measured the chassis and its square and straight; this car is good." I wasn't sure we were looking at the same vehicle. All I saw was frilly metal, the shut panels, floors, footwell, it goes on.



We moved to the other work bay, to view part B - a leaning stack of panels held back from slipping down by the seats, bumpers and containers. No grand reveal on this lot. Colin agreed the bumpers were a bit rough and the front cowl needed a fair bit of work. I waded through the panels, and surprisingly they were generally in good shape. The plastic containers held all the other parts that had been removed from the vehicle; nothing labelled, just tipped in, but they were there.

Bob, who owned the car, had a plan, but age and health had caught him out. He stripped the car many years ago to begin a restoration that never started. The car is

complete, and although the windscreen was missing, Colin was confident that it would show up as Bob's family continued to remove and work through years of big ideas from Bob's shed.



Overwhelmed and slightly despondent, I left Colin's workshop to process all I had seen. There are a number of steps one needs to work through before a decision is made to bring another Austin-Healey into the family. Number one on the list is Jennifer. I was expecting pushback, but only received encouragement. Not what I was looking for as I could leverage Jennifer's disapproval and take the easy route and walk away. Now I seriously need to think. Do I have the time? Do I have the capability? I am fairly handy, but a full restoration? I struggled for days.

I revisited the scene a week later to take a longer look and just chat with Colin about the restoration process. It is interesting how different things look after you have had time to think. Nothing had changed with the car, just my attitude and approach. I worked my way through the car to understand the extent of the effort and work required, taking into consideration Colin's genuine offer of support plus access to his expansive knowledge. I feel privileged to have that experience on my doorstep. There is no denying it is a massive job, but Colin was right and this car has potential. I wrestled with myself for days and I developed a level of sympathy for Bob, who I had never met and his BN1. It was a relief when I finally said to Colin, "I'll take it!"

Arriving back at Colin's place to tow the car home, he and his wife Kerrie met me along with a couple of friends that had stayed the night with them. That was

Project cont'

when Colin presented me with an Austin-Healey 100 BN1 brochure, and with warm sincerity he explained that the brochure was a gift from my father to him in 1978 as he restored his first Austin-Healey, that red BN1 I remember from the depot. My father had an old collection of car brochures. I have been through them many times as a boy, but did not recall the BN1 brochure. Dad would have picked it up from a dealer in '53 or '54 as a very young man. I had no idea that he gave it to Colin.



When the old dust coat came out and was handed to me, I could feel myself grinning. Before the 1970s, bus drivers wore dust coats, and the drivers in my grandfather's business wore grey dust coats with the family name embroidered into a logo on the breast pocket. I thought all of these coats had been lost to time. Colin, the collector of all things, had such a coat that he acquired in his early years at the bus depot. He gave it to me, "This is your family's memorabilia. It's time to hand it back." I felt my throat catch and I thanked him with slightly glazed eyes.



The BN1 (BN1/219266) is now in my shed; 1954 September built, originally finished in Healey Blue and delivered to Melbourne for the start of its journey in Australia.

Colin called a few weeks after the car arrived in my possession, "I've got the windscreen!" As the family cleaned out poor Bob's shed, there protected behind



an old sheet of fibro it sat intact, the complete screen. There are two stickers on the glass, a blue AHOC sticker and its last NSW registration label dated December 1974. It hasn't been on the road for 49 years. It was the project that Bob never got to finish. So Bob, I guess I will take it from here.



Footnote: Well, I've started; it's going to take some time, a very long time. I suspect that it will be a journey filled with pain, frustration and expense. I'm prepared for that. I will keep you posted.



Restoring Leaf Springs

Article Courtesy of the US magazine *Old Cars*



Leaf springs are arranged in "spring packs." They must be removed from the car before a spring can be restored by either cold setting or reshaping.

First, you must remove the leaf springs from the vehicle. If you're working with rusty original parts, you'll want to spray everything with WD-40 and let it sit a few days. Then, get the car up in the air and make sure it's safely supported. The old nuts and bolts will come off with an air-powered impact wrench, but try not to snap them. A spring shop may be able to find replacements, but don't count on it if you have a rare or foreign car.

To remove the springs, jack up the rear end and support the chassis in front of the front spring anchor. Take the weight off the axle with a small jack. Remove the nuts from the U-bolts that go through the support plates to secure the spring to the axle. Slowly and carefully lower the jack and remove the U-bolts. Remove the rear shackle pin nuts and outer shackle plate. Remove the inner plate with the shackle pins on it. Lower the rear end to the ground. Remove the pivot pin at the front spring eye. Lower the front of the spring down.



Loosening the nuts and locking nuts on the bottom of one of the U-bolts that holds the rear leaf springs on an MG TF. This particular "undersprung" car has the axle above the springs.

Accurate Alignment in Appleton, Wis., is one of a few shops in my area that still has the equipment to re-arch a spring by cold setting it. Each leaf is bent by a hydraulic press moving along it. The press should be at least 50-ton capacity to do a good job on car springs.



The two U-bolts hold one leaf spring on the car. The support plate bolts to the car chassis and the U-bolts go through the holes in it.

In order to work the leaves in the press, you have to take the spring pack apart. Before taking it apart, the professional will check the shop manual specs and make some measurements to help him determine the proper arch. Through sighting, measuring and other skills, a good spring man can figure almost precisely what a spring looked like when it was new.



After they are removed from the car, the spring packs should be carefully disassembled. Make sure they are clamped together so they don't fly apart.

Springs cont'

After they are removed from the car, the spring packs should be carefully disassembled. Make sure they are clamped together so they don't fly apart.

After disassembly and cleaning, the re-arching process starts. The first leaf to be worked is the longest one on the bottom of the pack. It is measured to determine a reference point near the center to work from. The leaf is then worked back and forth from center, a bit at a time, under the hydraulic press.

There is a rhythm to a spring bender's movements and just the right pressure has to be applied to the right point at the right time. If the pressure is too light, the spring steel will flex, rather than bend. If the pressure is too heavy, the spring will break. Working the leaf right to the tip is difficult and takes skill.

Once the longest leaf is done correctly, the others are arched to conform to it. Each gets a little more arch than the last. Companies that do cold setting say that springs that bend back and forth, instead of cold setting, have "lost temper." In this case, the only solution is making a new spring, but spring steel is no longer made in all "old car" sizes.



This spring is being re-arched using the cold-setting method. Eaton and possibly a few other companies can re-shape springs to original specs, but this is an expensive process that requires special equipment.

Mike Eaton at Eaton Detroit Spring, Inc., in Detroit says cold-setting steel is a temporary repair. "Spring steel never loses its temper unless it's heated," he said. "It's memory that springs lose, not their temper."

According to Eaton, the cold-setting method of re-arching springs results in a short-term fix. "Spring steel has a memory, and unless this memory is erased, the spring will eventually return to the height it was at prior to being re-arched."

Eaton says once a spring pack is re-arched, you can take a leaf out, lay it on the floor and chalk mark both ends. "Go back in a year and the spring will be back to its flattened-out length," he says. "Re-arching is a good quick-fix, but if you have a car worth restoring the ultimate way, re-shaping is best."

Eaton is one of few companies equipped to offer restorers "spring re-shaping" services. It can anneal a spring to take the memory out of it, re-shape it and re-heat treat it so that a new memory is put back in. In order to anneal a spring, it must be taken apart and visually inspected for fatigue. Each leaf is blasted clean. After being re-inspected, it is heated to 1,650 degrees Fahrenheit. Then, the leaf is placed on a pattern with the correct form and arch to re-shape that leaf.

The re-shaped leaf is quenched in special oil to cool it. This heating and quick cooling results in a leaf that is too hard or brittle to work well as a spring, so the leaf is heated again, for a set time, to 950 degrees. This process draws out some of the hardness. Once it cools, the leaf is shot-peened to relieve stress on it. The result is a spring that's re-tempered, re-shaped and re-heat-treated.

Re-shaping a classic car spring costs more than manufacturing a new spring. The minimum charge is about \$225 per spring assembly, and can be more. This doesn't include the cost of new bushings, spring liners, clips, re-assembly and shipping. Eaton does not re-use old parts.

Not every spring can be restored by reshaping. The condition of the spring has to be considered. If there are broken leaves, or if the leaves are separating at the ends, they probably can't be restored. Also, if

Springs cont'

there are pit marks on the flat sides of the springs, or crazing, they may not be candidates for restoration.

In many cases, it's best to look for reproduction parts or even used parts, but if you are restoring a valuable straight-axle Corvette to concours standards, you will want original springs made out of no-longer-available grooved spring steel. In this case, re-shaping probably makes economic sense.

There is certainly debate over whether it's a good idea to re-arch leaf springs by cold setting. Some say it gives a stiff ride. Others argue that the spring will lose its memory and settle back to its collapsed state in a short time. But, one Web site for Jeep enthusiasts points out that heavy truck suspension shops have re-arched springs for 50 years and wouldn't do it if it didn't work.

Austin-Healey 100s at the Australian Grand Prix

In case you missed it, there was a group of Austin-Healey 100s taking part in the drivers' parade at last Sunday's Australian Grand Prix. With the race in Melbourne, understandably the cars are owned by members of the AHOC Vic. All the cars that took

part were 100s in commemoration of the three 100s that took part in the 1953 AGP at Albert Park, now 70 years ago. The photos are not tremendous, but they are all that could be gathered together within the timeframe. PQ



Kris Long Photo



Ralph Warburton Photo



Ralph Warburton Photo



Your Last Page



Probably 1958 with the chassis of the new Austin-Healey Sprite up front, 100/6 behind with two Austin A40 Farinas in the background.

Thank you to Damien Carrick for the below



A Day in the Life of a British Car Owner"

Item# 01.023

Monthly Meetings

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm